

NBZ RESEARCH

Cysic

Deep-Dive Fundamental Analysis Report

\$CYS · ComputeFi — Decentralized ZK, AI & Mining Compute Network

\$1.46 Price (USD)	\$235.19M Market Cap	\$1.46B FDV	160.80M Circ. Supply (CYS)	#216 CMC Rank
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Blockchain Layer:	L1 — independent Cosmos CDK blockchain with an EVM-compatible execution layer (CometBFT/BFT consensus)
Protocol Type:	Decentralized "ComputeFi" marketplace — financializes GPU/ASIC/CPU compute for ZK proving, AI inference, and crypto mining, verified via Proof-of-Compute
Founded:	2022, Jersey City, USA — by Bowen Huang and Xiong "Leo" Fan
Total Raised (disclosed):	\$18M–\$21.85M across seed, pre-Series A, and a \$3.85M node sale (2023–2024)
Website:	cysic.xyz

Research by NBZ / NASIR

Institutional-style independent research. Data verified across multiple sources as of August 15, 2026.
Not financial advice.

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

Field	Detail
Project Name	Cysic
Token Ticker	\$CYS (dual-token model alongside non-transferable governance token \$CGT)
Blockchain Layer	L1 — Cysic Network is its own independent blockchain, built using Cosmos CDK (Cosmos SDK-based) with an EVM-compatible execution layer for smart contracts. It is not built on top of another chain, though it interoperates with and serves other ecosystems (Ethereum rollups, Aleo, zkSync, Scroll, and others) as a compute supplier.
Built On	Cosmos CDK (CometBFT/BFT consensus) for the base layer, with an EVM-compatible smart contract layer built on top for job scheduling, workload routing, and bridging.
Protocol Type	"ComputeFi" — a decentralized marketplace that financializes GPU, ASIC and CPU compute, transforming it into a programmable, verifiable, liquid resource for zero-knowledge (ZK) proof generation, AI inference, and cryptocurrency mining.
Founded	2022, by Bowen Huang and Xiong "Leo" Fan
HQ	Jersey City, New Jersey, USA
TGE Date	December 11, 2025
Contract Address	Native Cysic Network asset (dual-token: \$CYS transferable, \$CGT non-transferable governance token obtained via 1:1 staking); verify exact chain/contract details against official docs before interacting
Website	cysic.xyz
Total Raised	\$18M disclosed across 2 institutional rounds (per Tracxn/CoinLaunch), or \$21.85M including a separate \$3.85M node sale (29,000 nodes sold directly via the Cysic platform, per WEEEX) — figures vary by source depending on whether the node sale is counted as "funding"
Circulating Supply	160.80M CYS
Max Supply	1.00B CYS (fixed); initial circulating supply at TGE was reported at 150M CYS with a disclosed 3-year halving emissions schedule
Current Focus	Post-mainnet scaling (mainnet live since September/December 2025), deepening integrations with ZK ecosystems (Succinct, Boundless, Aleo, zkSync, Scroll) and AI verification use cases

Cysic is building what it calls "ComputeFi" — an attempt to do for computation what DeFi did for capital: turn a previously siloed, centralized resource (GPUs, ASIC miners, and servers) into a programmable, verifiable, and tradable asset class. Rather than being a general-purpose smart contract platform, Cysic Network is purpose-built infrastructure connecting compute providers (anyone from a single desktop GPU to an industrial ASIC cluster) with compute requesters (rollups needing zkSNARK proofs, AI developers needing inference capacity, or miners needing hashpower) through an on-chain marketplace with cryptographic and consensus-based verification of results.

The problem Cysic sets out to solve is threefold fragmentation: GPU rental platforms like Render Network and io.net serve AI inference but ignore ZK proving and mining; prover-as-a-service companies like Succinct and RiscZero serve ZK workloads but not AI or general compute; and traditional mining pools tokenize hashpower but can't flexibly reallocate it to other workload types. Cysic's stated ambition is to be the first genuinely workload-agnostic compute marketplace spanning all three categories simultaneously.

What differentiates Cysic most concretely from software-only competitors is its vertically integrated hardware strategy: rather than only coordinating existing GPUs software-side, Cysic designs its own custom ASICs specifically optimized for

zero-knowledge proof generation, operates GPU clusters with custom CUDA kernels, and sells consumer-friendly portable Bitcoin/Dogecoin miners to bring retail users into the network. This full-stack silicon-to-protocol integration is a materially more capital-intensive and operationally complex strategy than most crypto infrastructure projects attempt, and is the core basis of Cysic's claimed competitive differentiation.

02 TEAM & FOUNDERS

Name	Role	Background
Xiong Fan (Leo)	Co-Founder & CEO	Co-founded Cysic in 2022 and has served as its public-facing CEO through seed funding, pre-Series A, mainnet launch, and TGE. Maintains an active public web presence (personal website, X, LinkedIn) per the project's official team page.
Bowen Huang	Co-Founder	Co-founded Cysic alongside Xiong Fan in 2022; named as a co-founder in company-profile trackers (Tracxn), though not listed among the top-line team members on the project's own public team page referenced in this report — verify current role directly with the project.
Shervin Beyk	Head of Business Development	Leads partnership and business-development efforts, relevant to Cysic's growing list of ZK-ecosystem integrations (Succinct, Boundless, Aleo, zkSync, Scroll, Axiom, Nil, Talus, Herodotus).
Rae Wang (Ruihan)	Head of Operations	Oversees day-to-day operational execution for the network and its hardware/node programs.

Cysic's founding team has maintained continuity from the company's 2022 inception through its 2023 seed round, 2024 pre-Series A, September/December 2025 mainnet and TGE, and into its current post-launch phase — a multi-year build cycle typical of infrastructure-heavy projects that require significant hardware development lead time before shipping a usable product. This is a positive signal relative to projects that rush from idea to token launch in under a year, since Cysic's roughly three-year gap between founding and mainnet reflects the genuine complexity of designing custom ASICs and hardware infrastructure rather than purely software coordination.

Public information on the founders' pre-Cysic professional backgrounds (prior companies, technical credentials, academic pedigree) is limited in the sources reviewed for this report — team credibility here rests more on the strength of the company's investor roster (Polychain Capital and HashKey Capital led the earliest round, with OKX Ventures co-leading the follow-on) and on demonstrated execution (shipping actual custom silicon and a functioning mainnet) than on individually verifiable founder track records. Execution risk reads as moderate: hardware-based crypto infrastructure projects carry meaningfully higher operational and capital-intensity risk than pure software protocols, and Cysic's ability to continue funding and scaling its vertically integrated hardware strategy post-TGE is a key factor to monitor.

03 TECHNOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

Component	Description
Base layer	Cosmos CDK blockchain using CometBFT (Byzantine Fault Tolerant) consensus, tolerating up to one-third of nodes acting maliciously or failing without compromising network integrity.
Consensus mechanism	"Proof-of-Compute" — an extension of standard BFT consensus that factors in not just staked tokens but also the amount of verified computation a participant has pledged to the network.
Layered architecture	Four layers: (1) Hardware Layer — physical GPU/ASIC/FPGA/mobile devices; (2) Consensus Layer — Proof-of-Compute BFT; (3) Execution Layer — EVM-compatible smart contracts for job scheduling, routing, bridging and voting; (4) Product Layer — domain-specific modules (ZK proof market, AI inference framework, mining framework).
Custom hardware — ZK ASICs	Purpose-built application-specific integrated circuits for zero-knowledge proof generation, claimed to deliver orders-of-magnitude throughput and energy-efficiency improvements over commodity GPUs for ZK workloads specifically.
Custom hardware — GPU clusters	Optimized GPU clusters with custom CUDA kernels for AI inference and training, supporting both high-throughput and trust-minimized (verifiable) execution.
Custom hardware — portable miners	Consumer-friendly Bitcoin and Dogecoin miners branded under Cysic, designed for low energy cost and easy retail onboarding into the ComputeFi network.
Dual-token model	\$CYS is the transferable network token used for transaction fees, block rewards and network activity incentives. \$CGT is a non-transferable governance token obtained by staking \$CYS at a 1:1 ratio (unstaking takes longer than staking, per Cosmos SDK conventions) — compute providers must reserve \$CGT as collateral against malicious behavior.
Verification methods	Correctness is enforced differently per workload type: zkSNARK validity proofs for ZK tasks, redundancy (multiple providers computing the same result) for AI inference, and hash-difficulty verification for mining.
Ecosystem integrations	Official prover node operator for Succinct Network (processing 6 trillion cycles per public disclosures); integrations with Boundless, Aleo, zkSync, Scroll, Axiom, Nil, Talus and Herodotus.

In plain terms, Cysic works like a specialized job marketplace for computers instead of people: a "task requester" (say, an Ethereum rollup that needs a batch of transactions cryptographically proven) posts a job with a budget and deadline; "compute providers" — anyone from a single gaming GPU to an industrial ASIC farm — bid to do the work; the winning provider executes the task; and independent "verifiers" check that the result is correct before payment is released. The whole process, including bidding, execution and verification, is coordinated and recorded on Cysic's own blockchain.

The core technical differentiator is workload-agnostic verification: unlike a platform that only knows how to check one type of task, Cysic's protocol is designed to apply the right verification method to each job type — a zkSNARK proof can be checked with pure math (fast, certain), while an AI inference result might need multiple independent providers to compute the same answer and compare (redundancy-based, since AI outputs aren't as trivially provable as cryptographic proofs). This flexibility is what lets Cysic claim to serve ZK proving, AI inference and mining from a single unified marketplace, rather than requiring separate, incompatible platforms for each.

The vertically integrated hardware strategy is both Cysic's most distinctive technical claim and its biggest operational risk concentration: designing and manufacturing custom ASICs is capital-intensive, has long lead times, and exposes the company to hardware supply chain risk in a way that pure software coordination platforms (like Akash or io.net) do not face. If Cysic's custom silicon genuinely delivers the claimed order-of-magnitude efficiency gains for ZK workloads specifically, this could be a durable moat; if the hardware roadmap slips or underdelivers, Cysic's core differentiation versus software-coordination-only competitors would be substantially weakened.

04 USE CASES & REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS

Use Case	Description	Status
Ethereum/rollup ZK proving	Real-time block proving and zkSNARK generation for rollups and privacy-focused L1s, distributed across the provider network.	Live
Succinct Network prover node	Cysic operates as an official prover node operator for Succinct, reportedly processing 6 trillion cycles.	Live
Verifiable AI inference	On-demand LLM/ML inference where multiple providers cross-check outputs via redundancy, enabling pay-per-correct-result AI APIs.	Live
Bitcoin/Dogecoin mining integration	Portable consumer miners plug directly into ComputeFi, letting retail hashpower flexibly serve secondary ZK/AI workloads when profitable.	Live
Scientific / HPC compute	Positioned for genomics, climate modeling and 3D rendering use cases needing affordable, verifiable compute outside centralized cloud providers.	Early / roadmap
ZK ecosystem integrations	Active integrations with Aleo, zkSync, Scroll, Axiom, Nil, Talus, Herodotus and Boundless.	Live
Node/hardware sales program	29,000 compute nodes sold directly to the community, raising \$3.85M and distributing network participation broadly among retail hardware operators.	Completed (2023-24)
Testnet activity (pre-mainnet)	Multi-phase testnet program (Phase I mid-2024 onward) validating custom ZK hardware ahead of mainnet, including an initial CYS/CGT airdrop to early contributors.	Completed

Real usage signals for Cysic are unusually concrete for a project that only reached mainnet in late 2025: at launch, the company reported the network had already processed over 13 million transactions for more than 1.35 million users during its testnet phases, and separate mainnet-launch disclosures cite 1.4 million unique wallets, 260,000+ active nodes, and over 10 million ZK proofs delivered. These figures, if accurate, would represent meaningfully larger pre-launch engagement than most infrastructure projects achieve, though — as with the other self-reported usage metrics discussed elsewhere in this research series — they originate from company and press disclosures rather than independently audited on-chain dashboards.

The most credible, verifiable-in-principle demand driver is Cysic's role as an official Succinct Network prover node, since Succinct is itself an established, independently operating ZK infrastructure project — genuine third-party integration of this kind is a stronger signal than self-reported volume alone. The broader decentralized-compute category, however, faces a well-documented credibility challenge: independent analysis published in early 2026 argues that established competitors like Akash and Render generate revenue that remains "trivial" next to centralized cloud providers (Akash ~\$11M and Render ~\$18M in Q3 2025 revenue, versus AWS's \$100B+ annual run rate), and that verification in this category has historically been weaker than marketed — citing real 2025 incidents of corrupted results and Sybil attacks on rival networks. Cysic's Proof-of-Compute and multi-method verification approach is explicitly positioned to address this exact category-wide credibility gap, but has not yet been tested at the same revenue scale as its established competitors.

05 COMMUNITY & ECOSYSTEM

Metric	Data
Pre-mainnet testnet engagement	13M+ transactions processed, 1.35M+ users, per company disclosures ahead of mainnet
Mainnet-launch metrics	1.4M unique wallets, 260,000+ active nodes, 10M+ ZK proofs delivered, per official launch disclosures
Node/hardware sale participation	29,000 compute nodes sold directly to the community (node sale raised \$3.85M)
Airdrop / ecosystem campaigns	KaitoAI leaderboard pre-TGE campaign; OKX Web3 Launch airdrop program distributing 984,252 CYS (claims opened Feb 10, 2026); 0.6% of total supply designated for the Kaito ecosystem partnership
Performance benchmarks	4-minute-50-second zkVM proving speed and 1.3M Keccak/sec processing capacity reported via proprietary ZK chip network, per third-party project trackers
24h trading volume	\$94.27M — a large figure relative to market cap, reflecting active, liquid trading interest around this report's snapshot date
Ecosystem partnerships	Succinct Network (official prover node), Boundless, Aleo, zkSync, Scroll, Axiom, Nil, Talus, Herodotus, BTQ
Exchange listings	Gate, KuCoin, Bitget, MEXC, LBank, Bitunix, Hotcoin, BingX, CoinEx and others

Cysic's community engagement metrics, if taken at face value, are substantial for a project at this stage — over a million unique wallets and hundreds of thousands of active nodes ahead of and immediately following mainnet launch would place it well ahead of most comparable infrastructure projects at a similar point in their lifecycle. The node-sale program (29,000 hardware nodes sold directly to the community) is a particularly notable community-building mechanism, since it ties genuine hardware ownership and network participation together rather than relying solely on a passive token airdrop.

As with usage metrics discussed in Section 04, these community figures are self-reported by the company and its close ecosystem partners (press releases, GlobeNewswire announcements, exchange-hosted learn articles) rather than independently verified by a neutral third party in the sources reviewed here. The Succinct Network prover-node relationship stands out as the most independently verifiable ecosystem signal, since it depends on continued technical integration with an established external project rather than purely internal Cysic metrics. The active OKX Web3 Launch airdrop and Kaito ecosystem campaigns suggest continued, well-resourced marketing and community-growth investment in the months following TGE.

06 INVESTORS & PARTNERSHIPS

Round	Date	Amount	Lead Investor(s)
Seed	Feb 17, 2023	\$6.0M	Polychain Capital, HashKey Capital
Pre-Series A	May 24, 2024	\$12.0M	HashKey Capital, OKX Ventures
Node Sale (community, not equity)	2023-2024	\$3.85M	29,000 nodes sold directly via the Cysic platform
Cumulative disclosed total	2023-2024	\$18.0M (institutional rounds only) / \$21.85M (including node sale)	—

Tier	Investor	Type
Tier 1	Polychain Capital (Lead)	Venture
Tier 1	HashKey Capital (Lead)	Venture
Tier 2	OKX Ventures (Lead, pre-Series A)	Exchange
Tier 3	SNZ Holding	Venture
Tier 3	ABCDE	Venture
Tier 3	Web3.com Ventures	Venture
Tier 4	IDG Capital	Venture
Tier 4	Matrix Partners	Venture
Other	A&T; Capital	Venture
Other	CoinSwitch	Corporation
Other	Web3 Foundation	Corporation
Other	Bit Digital	Corporation

Cysic's investor roster carries genuine weight for an infrastructure project of its size: Polychain Capital and HashKey Capital co-led the earliest institutional round, and HashKey returned alongside OKX Ventures to co-lead the larger pre-Series A a year later — repeat institutional conviction across funding cycles is a more meaningful signal than isolated single-round participation. OKX Ventures' direct exchange-affiliated backing also plausibly helped facilitate Cysic's exchange-driven distribution strategy post-TGE (including the OKX Web3 Launch airdrop program noted in Section 05).

The presence of Bit Digital — a publicly traded Bitcoin mining and digital infrastructure company — among Cysic's backers is a notable strategic signal specific to this project's hardware-centric model: an established mining infrastructure operator choosing to back Cysic suggests some degree of industry validation for the ComputeFi thesis from participants with direct operational expertise in large-scale compute hardware, a different kind of strategic value than a pure financial VC would bring. The broader Tier 3-4 roster (SNZ Holding, ABCDE, IDG Capital, Matrix Partners) is a credible but not exceptional set of participants relative to the strongest rosters in this research series (e.g., Internet Computer's a16z/Polychain backing, Secret Network's HashKey/Spartan/Dragonfly roster).

07

TOKENOMICS

Parameter	Value
Max Supply	1,000,000,000 CYS (fixed)
Total Supply	1.00B CYS
Circulating Supply	160.80M CYS (~16.1% of max supply)
Initial circulating supply (at TGE)	Reported at 150M CYS
TGE Date	December 11, 2025
Emissions schedule	Disclosed 3-year halving schedule for new CYS issuance
Governance token (\$CGT)	Non-transferable; obtained via 1:1 staking of \$CYS; unstaking takes longer than staking per Cosmos SDK design; required as collateral for compute providers to defend against malicious behavior

Category	%	Notes
Ecosystem Incentives	40.2%	The largest single category by a wide margin — funds network growth, provider/verifier incentives, and ecosystem development programs
Investors	23.6%	Combined seed and pre-Series A allocation; fully locked with unlock beginning per vesting schedule (marked "23.6%" under the unlock column in the project's own vesting dashboard, indicating this tranche becomes available over time rather than instantly)
Community Incentives	16.1%	Marked as available at TGE per the project's own vesting dashboard ("16.1%" shown under the initial-unlock column) — the primary source of tokens distributed to users at launch
Contributors	12.1%	Team/core contributor allocation, subject to vesting (marked as locked at TGE per the project's dashboard, with the full 12.1% shown under the later-unlock column)
Foundation Treasury	8.0%	Held for ongoing foundation operations and future strategic needs, subject to vesting (shown as locked at TGE, unlocking over time)

CYS's allocation is dominated by Ecosystem Incentives at 40.2% of total supply — a substantially larger ecosystem-growth allocation than most other projects reviewed in this research series, reflecting Cysic's need to continuously incentivize a large, distributed base of hardware providers (GPU owners, ASIC operators, portable miner users) to keep contributing compute to the network. Investors (23.6%) and Contributors (12.1%) together total roughly 35.7% of supply — a meaningful insider allocation, though smaller in combined weight than the Ecosystem Incentives bucket alone.

Based on the project's own vesting dashboard breakdown captured in this report's source screenshots, Community Incentives (16.1%) appear to have been available at or near TGE, while Investors (23.6%), Contributors (12.1%) and Foundation Treasury (8%) — together representing 43.7% of total supply — remain locked and subject to a vesting schedule extending beyond launch. This structure is broadly consistent with standard venture-backed token designs reviewed elsewhere in this series: a modest immediate community float, with the larger insider and ecosystem allocations unlocking progressively over subsequent years, creating an ongoing dilution overhang investors should track as vesting cliffs are reached.

Token demand is anchored in direct network utility: \$CYS is required to pay transaction fees and is distributed as block rewards, while staking \$CYS into non-transferable \$CGT is mandatory for compute providers who want to participate in and earn from the network, creating a structural, usage-linked source of ongoing token demand distinct from purely speculative holding. The disclosed 3-year halving emissions schedule additionally provides a predictable, diminishing new-supply curve, though the exact near-term inflation rate implied by that schedule was not independently detailed in the sources reviewed for this report and should be verified directly against official tokenomics documentation.

08 MARKET OVERVIEW

Metric	Value
Current Price	~\$1.46 (exchange pairs ranged \$1.45–\$1.47 across Gate, KuCoin, Bitget, MEXC, LBank, Bitunix, Hotcoin, BingX, CoinEx)
24h Range	\$0.9819 – \$1.510
Market Cap	\$235.19M
Fully Diluted Market Cap	\$1.46B
24h Volume	\$94.27M
Circulating Supply	160.80M CYS
Total / Max Supply	1.00B / 1.00B CYS
All-Time High	\$1.692
All-Time Low	\$0.1250
CMC Rank	#216 (general), #132 (on the project-specific market page referenced)
Price Change — 24h / 7d / 30d / 90d / YTD	+50.55% / +37.06% / +363% / +186% / +318% — an exceptionally strong recent rally across every timeframe shown
Key Exchange Listings	Gate, KuCoin, Bitget, MEXC, LBank, Bitunix, Hotcoin, BingX, CoinEx

CYS's price action captured in this report is unusually strong across every timeframe: up over 50% in 24 hours, 37% over 7 days, 363% over 30 days, and 318% year-to-date, alongside a 24h trading volume (\$94.27M) representing roughly 40% of total market cap — indicating this snapshot captures the token in the midst of an active, high-momentum rally rather than a stable trading range. From a low near its all-time low of \$0.1250, CYS has recovered substantially and is now trading much closer to its all-time high of \$1.692, a level reached relatively recently given the token's TGE was only in December 2025.

This trajectory — a sharp post-TGE decline toward the all-time low, followed by a dramatic multi-month recovery rally — is a distinctly different pattern from every other project reviewed in this research series, most of which have shown either sustained post-TGE decline (Folks Finance, Internet Computer, Secret Network) or a more contained post-launch stabilization (Genius Terminal). The scale of the recent rally (363% over 30 days) suggests this period likely coincides with a specific, identifiable catalyst — potentially the OKX Web3 Launch airdrop claim window (opened February 10, 2026), continued mainnet adoption momentum, or broader sector-wide enthusiasm for AI/compute-infrastructure tokens — though the precise driver was not independently pinpointed in the sources reviewed for this report and would benefit from direct verification against a live price chart before drawing firm conclusions.

The magnitude and consistency of this rally across all timeframes also warrants some caution: such rapid, broad-based appreciation can reflect either genuine, durable fundamental re-rating or a shorter-term speculative/momentum-driven move that may be vulnerable to a sharp reversal — a pattern worth monitoring closely against the network's underlying usage metrics (Section 05) rather than assuming price performance alone confirms fundamental strength.

COMPETITORS & MARKET POSITION

Project	Type / Chain	Market Cap	vs. Cysic
Render Network	GPU rental for rendering/AI	Established mid-cap	Focused specifically on GPU rendering and AI inference but lacks ZK verification or mining integration; per independent 2026 analysis, generated only ~\$18M in Q3 2025 revenue — illustrating the category-wide gap versus centralized cloud incumbents that Cysic also faces
io.net	GPU rental for AI/ML	Established mid-cap	Strong specific focus on AI/ML GPU rental with claimed 70% cost savings vs. AWS/GCP, but does not extend to ZK proving or mining — narrower scope than Cysic's workload-agnostic approach
Akash Network	General-purpose decentralized cloud compute	Established mid-cap	Broader, more general-purpose compute marketplace but without cryptographic verifiability built in; generated ~\$11M in Q3 2025 revenue per independent analysis — again illustrating the category's current revenue ceiling relative to centralized cloud
Succinct / RiscZero	ZK proving-as-a-service	Comparable/smaller, ZK-focused	Direct competitors in the ZK-proving niche specifically, though Cysic is also an official Succinct prover node operator — a partial coopetition relationship rather than pure rivalry; neither Succinct nor RiscZero extends into AI inference or mining the way Cysic claims to
Boundless (ZKC)	ZK infrastructure token	Comparable early-stage	Closely related ZK infrastructure competitor and Cysic ecosystem partner simultaneously; used by third-party analysts as a valuation comparable for CYS given the overlapping ZK-proving market and similar early-stage token profile
Traditional mining pools	Centralized/pooled hashpower	Large, established	Tokenize hashpower but cannot flexibly reallocate it to ZK or AI workloads — Cysic's portable-miner integration directly targets this inflexibility as a differentiator

Cysic's competitive positioning rests almost entirely on its claim to workload-agnosticism: while every named competitor specializes narrowly (Render/io.net in AI GPU rental, Succinct/RiscZero in ZK proving, Akash in general compute, mining pools in hashpower), Cysic argues no other project combines ZK proving, AI inference, and mining hashpower into a single, cryptographically verified marketplace with its own purpose-built silicon underneath. If genuinely differentiated and durable, this breadth could be a real moat; the more skeptical reading is that spreading focus across three distinct, technically demanding compute categories (each with different verification challenges) is also a harder execution problem than any single-category competitor faces.

The broader decentralized-compute category itself faces a credibility challenge independent of any single project's execution: as the independent March 2026 analysis cited in Section 04 argues, category leaders Akash and Render generate revenue that remains trivial next to centralized cloud incumbents, and verification quality across the category has historically been weaker than marketed, with real 2025 incidents of corrupted results and Sybil-gamed reputation systems at competing networks. Cysic's Proof-of-Compute consensus and its official role as a Succinct prover node are its strongest

concrete answers to this category-wide skepticism, but the network's true verification robustness at scale remains to be proven over a longer operating history, similar to the way Aave's dominant position took years to establish relative to newer DeFi lending challengers.

The biggest structural threat is less any single named competitor and more the risk that the entire decentralized-compute thesis fails to close the revenue gap with centralized cloud providers within a commercially meaningful timeframe — if AWS, Google Cloud and Azure continue to dominate on cost, reliability and ease of use for the vast majority of real-world AI and compute workloads, even a best-executed, genuinely differentiated project like Cysic could struggle to grow beyond a niche, crypto-native user base.

10 RECENT NEWS & UPDATES

Date	Event
2022	Cysic founded in Jersey City, USA, by Bowen Huang and Xiong "Leo" Fan
Oct 16, 2023	Cysic announces an ecosystem partnership with BTQ over Keelung, a zero-knowledge domain-specific language
Feb 17, 2023	Cysic closes a \$6M seed round led by Polychain Capital and HashKey Capital, with participation from SNZ Holding, A&T; Capital, ABCDE and Web3.com Ventures
Mid-2024	Testnet Phase I launches, validating custom ZK hardware and introducing an initial CYS/CGT airdrop to early contributors
May 24, 2024	Cysic closes a \$12M pre-Series A round led by HashKey Capital and OKX Ventures, with participation from IDG Capital, Matrix Partners and others, bringing total disclosed institutional funding to \$18M
2023-2024	Node sale program sells 29,000 compute nodes directly to the community, raising an additional \$3.85M
Sep 29, 2025	Cysic posts a cryptic "eye chart" teaser on X, signaling an imminent mainnet launch
Sep 2025	Cysic mainnet goes live per multiple project trackers, quickly processing over 13 million transactions for more than 1.35 million users during its early operating period
Dec 11, 2025	Official Cysic mainnet launch announcement (GlobeNewswire) and CYS Token Generation Event conclude on the same date, with the network reporting 1.4M unique wallets, 260,000+ nodes, and 10M+ ZK proofs delivered
Dec 2025	Cysic operates as an official Succinct Network prover node, reportedly processing 6 trillion cycles
Feb 10, 2026	OKX Web3 Launch airdrop program for Cysic opens claims, distributing 984,252 CYS to eligible participants
Early-mid 2026	CYS price recovers sharply from levels near its all-time low, posting reported gains of 318% year-to-date and 363% over a trailing 30-day period as of this report's snapshot
Mar 2026	Independent industry analysis (TradingView/Cointelegraph) argues the broader decentralized-compute category, including established players like Akash and Render, has yet to prove genuine verification robustness or revenue scale — relevant context for evaluating Cysic's own claims
Aug 15, 2026 (snapshot)	CYS trading around \$1.46, market cap ~\$235M, up sharply across all measured timeframes and trading well above its post-TGE lows

The news timeline shows a team that executed a fairly disciplined, multi-year infrastructure build cycle: roughly three years from founding to mainnet, with two institutional funding rounds and an extensive multi-phase testnet program (including a genuine hardware node sale to the community) preceding the actual token launch. This sequencing — building and testing extensively before tokenizing — compares favorably to projects in this research series that launched tokens closer to or even ahead of full product maturity.

The most defining events are the December 2025 mainnet launch and TGE, which represented the culmination of roughly three years of hardware and protocol development, and the subsequent sharp price recovery through early-to-mid 2026 — a trajectory notably different from most other projects reviewed in this series, where post-TGE performance has generally trended toward multi-month or multi-year decline rather than recovery. Whether this recovery reflects durable fundamental strength (real compute demand catching up to the network's hardware investment) or a shorter-term speculative rally is the single most important open question for anyone evaluating CYS at the time of this report.

11 INVESTMENT POTENTIAL & RISKS

BULL CASE

- + Genuinely differentiated, vertically integrated hardware strategy (custom ZK ASICs, GPU clusters, portable miners) — a materially harder-to-replicate moat than software-only compute-coordination competitors
- + Credible institutional backing with repeat conviction (HashKey Capital led/co-led both major rounds; Polychain Capital and OKX Ventures also participated), plus strategic validation from mining infrastructure operator Bit Digital
- + Disciplined multi-year build cycle (2022 founding to December 2025 mainnet/TGE) with extensive testnet validation and a genuine community hardware sale (29,000 nodes) ahead of token launch
- + Substantial pre-launch and launch-stage engagement metrics (1.4M+ unique wallets, 260,000+ nodes, 10M+ ZK proofs delivered per company disclosures)
- + Concrete, independently verifiable ecosystem integration as an official Succinct Network prover node, reportedly processing 6 trillion cycles
- + Workload-agnostic design (ZK + AI + mining in one marketplace) directly targets a real fragmentation problem that narrower single-category competitors do not solve
- + Strong, broad-based price recovery (+318% YTD, +363% 30-day as of this report) suggests renewed market conviction following a difficult post-TGE period
- + Fixed 1B max supply with a disclosed 3-year halving emissions schedule provides more predictable long-term dilution mechanics than uncapped-supply competitors

BEAR CASE

- Very young mainnet and token — live for well under a year as of this report, with limited long-term operating history to evaluate durability
- Hardware-centric strategy carries meaningfully higher capital intensity and operational/supply-chain risk than pure software coordination platforms, increasing execution risk if hardware development or manufacturing slips
- The broader decentralized-compute category has a documented credibility gap: established leaders generate revenue that remains trivial relative to centralized cloud incumbents, and verification quality across the category has been weaker than marketed in some cases
- Roughly 43.7% of total supply (Investors, Contributors, Foundation Treasury) remains locked and subject to future vesting, representing an ongoing dilution overhang as cliffs are reached
- Headline usage and engagement metrics are self-reported by the company and its close partners rather than independently audited in the sources reviewed here
- The scale and consistency of CYS's recent price rally (up over 300% across multiple timeframes simultaneously) raises the possibility of a speculative, momentum-driven move that could be vulnerable to a sharp reversal if not backed by proportional usage growth
- Faces both narrow, established single-category competitors (Render, io.net, Succinct, Akash) and the risk that any of them could expand into adjacent workload types, eroding Cysic's core workload-agnostic differentiation
- Total disclosed funding (\$18M-\$21.85M depending on methodology) is comparatively modest next to the capital intensity typically required for competitive, cutting-edge custom silicon development at scale

Risk Factor	Detailed Explanation
Hardware execution risk	Custom ASIC design and manufacturing is capital-intensive with long lead times; any delays, defects, or supply-chain disruptions could directly undermine Cysic's core differentiation versus software-only competitors.
Category-wide revenue credibility gap	Independent analysis shows even established decentralized-compute leaders generate revenue far below centralized cloud incumbents; Cysic must prove it can outperform this pattern rather than simply replicate it with additional workload types.

Risk Factor	Detailed Explanation
Verification robustness unproven at scale	Proof-of-Compute and multi-method verification are promising in design, but the network's true resistance to Sybil attacks, collusion, and result manipulation has not been tested over the multi-year timeframes that have revealed weaknesses at competing networks.
Token unlock overhang	With roughly 43.7% of supply still locked among Investors, Contributors and Foundation Treasury, future vesting cliffs represent a structural dilution risk to monitor.
Price momentum / mean-reversion risk	The scale of CYS's recent rally across every timeframe raises the possibility that price has run ahead of fundamentals; a sharp reversal is a realistic scenario if usage growth does not keep pace.
Self-reported metrics	Headline usage figures (wallets, nodes, proofs delivered) originate primarily from company and partner disclosures rather than independently audited dashboards in the sources reviewed here.

NBZ RESEARCH VERDICT

Cysic is worth attention as one of the more technically ambitious and operationally differentiated plays in the decentralized-compute category, distinguished by its vertically integrated custom-hardware strategy and a disciplined multi-year build cycle that culminated in a substantive mainnet launch and genuine third-party integration (as an official Succinct Network prover node) rather than a purely speculative token event. The project's workload-agnostic thesis — unifying ZK proving, AI inference and mining into one verified marketplace — directly targets a real fragmentation problem, and its recent price recovery suggests renewed market conviction following a difficult post-TGE period. That said, Cysic operates within a broader decentralized-compute category that has, so far, struggled to generate revenue at a scale that meaningfully challenges centralized cloud incumbents, and its own headline usage metrics remain self-reported rather than independently audited. A durable bullish case requires Cysic's custom silicon to deliver genuinely differentiated performance at scale, its verification model to prove robust against the Sybil and collusion attacks that have troubled competing networks, and its recent price strength to be validated by continued, provable usage growth rather than momentum alone. The most critical risks are hardware execution risk given the project's capital-intensive strategy, and the pending dilution from roughly 44% of supply still locked among investors and contributors. On balance, Cysic reads as a credible, differentiated infrastructure bet in an as-yet-unproven category, best suited to those comfortable underwriting both company-specific execution risk and the broader sector's still-unresolved path to real commercial scale. Not financial advice.

SOURCES CONSULTED: cysic.xyz · hackmd.io/@Cysic (Cysic Network Whitepaper) · Phemex Academy · Tracxn · BSC News · ChainCatcher · WEEX Crypto Wiki · ICO Drops · CoinLaunch · GlobeNewswire · AIXBT.tech · MEXC Learn · io.net blog · Own Your Mind (Render/Akash/io.net revenue comparison) · TradingView/Cointelegraph (decentralized compute category analysis) · Bitget Academy · BingX Learn · CB Insights (Cysic competitors) · user-supplied CoinMarketCap-style app screenshots (CYS market stats, allocations, exchange markets, team page, investor list). Prices, volume, funding and market data are point-in-time snapshots as of August 15, 2026 and change continuously; self-reported company usage metrics have not been independently audited and should be verified before relying on them for decisions.

NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE.